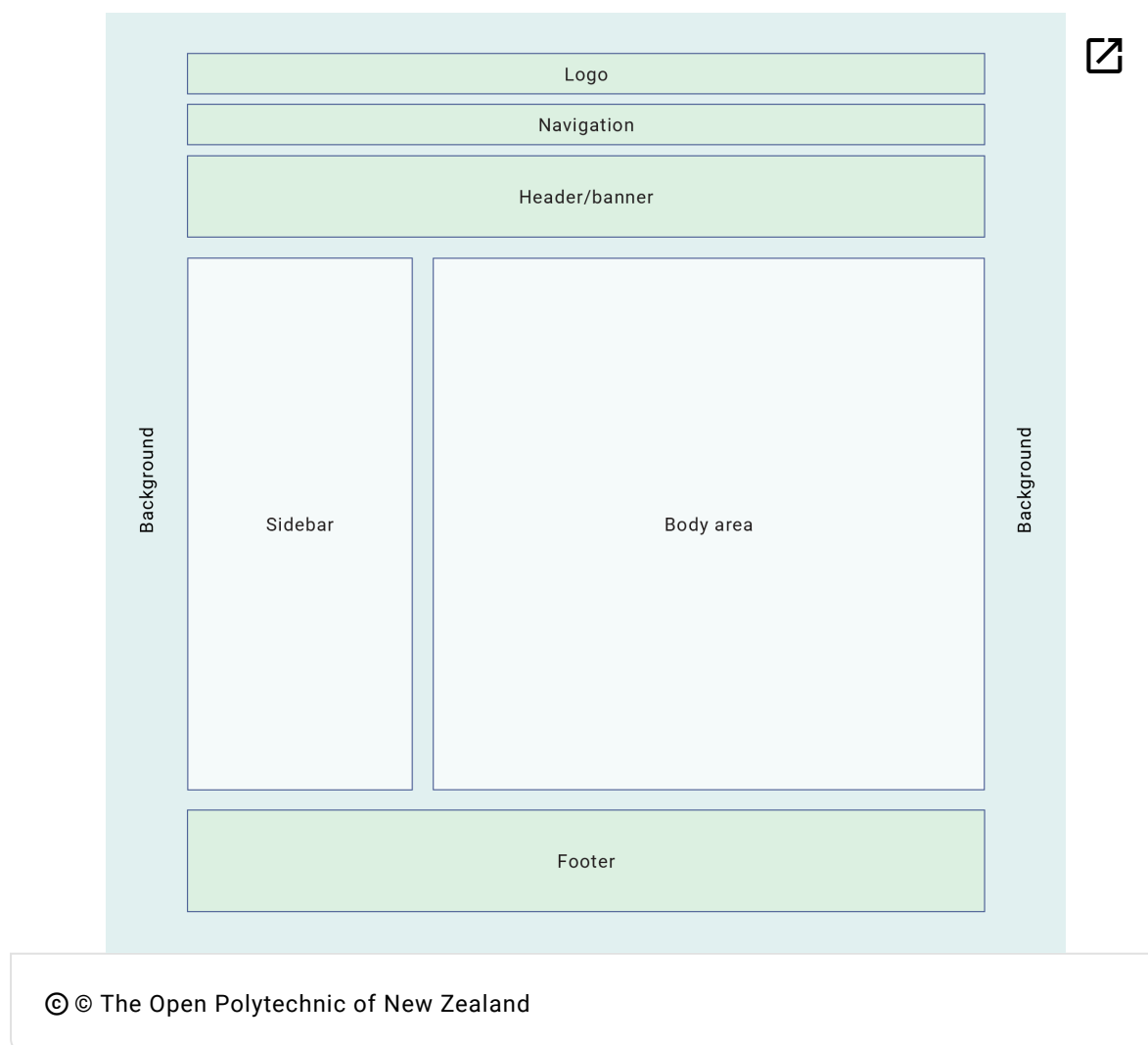




Wireframing 30m



[Skip to main content](#)

When creating content with HTML, it's often a good idea to have some guidance on how the pages should look. This helps with the layout, structure and branding of the page. It's also part of the user interface (UI) design process, which we use when designing HTML content.

In **Topic 1**, we briefly mentioned wireframes as part of layout design. We discussed elements like headers and footers, banners and sliders, menus and navigation and content container sections.



If you need a refresher about this, we recommend taking a look at the following pages:

Layout: Key sections →

These sections are important because we'll use HTML elements to create them. Later on, these sections will be generated by program code, but before we get to that stage, we need to understand how to create them manually.

Wireframes help us define the boundaries of these sections, so we can eventually write code to match the layout. For example, you might write simple code to separate the sections, though as you learn more about CSS, you'll discover how to divide them properly.

The key idea is that wireframes guide us in designing the layout of the sections. If you've worked with a content management system (CMS), you might have noticed that the theme or template describes the page structure for you. If you look closely at the template code, you'll see many HTML `<div>` tags and CSS styling used to define the layout.



[Skip to main content](#)

HTML

CSS

Result

EDIT ON

LIVE

```
body {  
  font-family: Arial, sans-serif;  
  margin: 0;  
  padding: 0;  
  box-sizing: border-box;  
}  
  
.header, .footer {  
  width: 100%;  
  background-color: #f8f9fa;  
  text-align: center;  
  padding: 20px;  
  box-shadow: 0 2px 4px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.1);  
}  
  
.content {  
  display: flex;  
  justify-content: space-between;  
  padding: 20px;  
}  
  
.sidebar, .main-content {  
  padding: 20px;  
  background-color: #e9ecef;  
  box-shadow: 0 2px 4px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.1);  
}
```

Resources1x0.5x0.25xRerun

Example 5.2 Wireframing



Thoughts on this page?



Skip to main content

HTML wireframes

Share your own approach to writing clean and maintainable HTML based on wireframes. Discuss any challenges you've faced in similar tasks and provide tips or resources for learning semantic HTML.

B ***I***  

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Jorge Andres Guerrero Giraldo 14 Jan 2026, 9:02 AM

My approach to writing clean and maintainable HTML from a wireframe is to treat the wireframe as a structural contract. I start by translating each wireframe block into semantic landmarks and content sections. For example, the logo and navigation belong in a `header`, the primary content belongs in `main`, supporting content fits well in an `aside`, and the page ending information goes in `footer`. I then build a simple HTML skeleton first, with correct heading order and meaningful grouping, before adding any styling.

To keep the markup maintainable, I aim for minimal nesting, consistent indentation, and clear section boundaries. I also use patterns that match the wireframe layout without forcing visual decisions into HTML. A simple structure for the provided layout could be:

[Skip to main content](#)

```
<header>
  <div class="logo">Logo</div>
  <nav aria-label="Primary">
    <ul>
      <li><a href="#">Home</a></li>
      <li><a href="#">Shop</a></li>
    </ul>
  </nav>
  <div class="banner">Header or banner</div>
</header>

<main>
  <aside>Sidebar</aside>
  <section>
    <h1>Main content</h1>
    <p>Body area</p>
  </section>
</main>

<footer>Footer</footer>
```

